cadence

ONE REVIEWED CHAPTER

Notes, pulse and space

A small piano chapter for learning how to read, keep a pulse, and leave room for silence. Take one phrase at a time.

01 Find a comfortable pulse

Count 1, 2, 3, 4 evenly. Tap once on each number, then keep counting while you imagine the taps. A click can help you begin.

02 Small steps, steady pulse

Read the four bars on page 2. Middle C is the first note.
Listen, locate the notes, then play slowly with your right hand.
The left hand rests. If a note is uncertain, remove the time pressure.

03 Make room for the spaces

Page 3 mixes quarter notes, half notes and rests. Count through each space. A rest is part of the phrase, not a cue to stop counting.

Try an idea of your own

When the first phrase feels familiar, choose a different final note.
Listen to its effect. Does it sound settled, or as if it wants to continue?
This variation is an invitation to explore, not a scored test.

Suggested start: 60 bpm, 4/4, one short visit at a time.

EXERCISE 1

Small steps, steady pulse

Piano - right hand. Left hand rests. 4/4, quarter note = 60.
Read each written bar once. Count through notes and rests.

After playing

Name one thing that became easier and one place to revisit.
Then try again another day, with less help if that feels comfortable.

EXERCISE 2

Make room for the spaces

Piano - right hand. Left hand rests. 4/4, quarter note = 60.
Read each written bar once. Count through notes and rests.

After playing

Name one thing that became easier and one place to revisit.
Then try again another day, with less help if that feels comfortable.